



EXPORTER GUIDE TO CÔTE D'IVOIRE



The **Côte d'Ivoire Ministry of Trade, Industry and SME** regulates the import of certain products through its **Verification of Conformity programme**. The authority requires that all regulated products undergo a conformity assessment and be issued a valid **Certificate of Conformity (COC)**.

The VOC (Verification of Conformity) programme aims to protect the people, businesses and environment of Côte d'Ivoire from unsafe and substandard products. The programme will also promote fair competition for local manufacturers and traders.

To ensure the harmonized compliance to set safety standards and regulations, the Côte d'Ivoire Ministry of Trade, Industry and SME appointed **Cotecna Inspection S.A** (Cotecna) to issue Certificates of Conformity (COC) on its behalf. The Cotecna mandate covers the **testing, inspection and certification** of all Côte d'Ivoire regulated imported products.

REGULATED PRODUCTS

All regulated products exported to Côte d'Ivoire require a mandatory Certificate of Conformity (COC) for successful import. The COC is a mandatory document for complete Customs clearance at the ports of entry into the country.

According to Decree 2016-1152, the following product categories are subject to regulation:

1. Food products
2. Electrical, electronic or renewable energy products
3. Cosmetic and hygiene products
4. Building materials
5. Packaging
6. Spare parts and automotive accessories and lubricants
7. Machines
8. Pressure equipment
9. Personal Protective Equipment
10. Other products related to health, safety and the environment
11. Textiles
12. Shoes
13. Toys

For the complete product list, please contact **Cotecna Côte d'Ivoire** or your nearest **Cotecna office**.



However, other imported products can also be certified. **Voluntary certification** offers benefits such as, faster customs clearance and reducing the risk of your products being denied entry into Côte d'Ivoire.

Sensitive Products

Every consignment containing the following "sensitive" products must be accompanied by a mandatory Certificate of Conformity (COC):

- > Milk and dairy products
- > Rice
- > Flour
- > Table salt
- > Fertilizer

For the sensitive product certification process, please refer to **Route A** below.

Exempted products

The following products are exempted from certification under the Côte d'Ivoire VOC programme:

- > Gold and other precious metals
- > Precious stones
- > Explosives, weapons, ammunition and other war material intended for the National Armed Forces and to the Forces of Law and Order
- > Live animals
- > Fresh vegetables and fresh fruits
- > Fresh, deep-frozen and frozen fish
- > Fresh, deep-frozen and frozen meat
- > Plants and floricultural products
- > Local products and traditional handicraft from community
- > Medicine and inputs used in the manufacturing of medicine
- > Newspapers and periodicals, postage stamps and duty stamps, stamped papers, banknotes, cheque books, passports and certain printed documents
- > Personal effects and used household objects
- > Used vehicles
- > Crude or partially refined petroleum
- > Commercial samples
- > Supplies to diplomatic and consular missions or international organizations, imported for their own use
- > Imported goods and equipment for oil and mining operations (benefiting from the Mining and Petroleum Codes)
- > Imports related to Customs Free Zones



- > Production machines submitted or exempted under the Investment Code on request made to the VOC Monitoring Committee
- > Local industries willing to get exoneration for some raw materials for their production, are required to contact the VOC Monitoring Committee of the VOC Programme to pre-register them and benefit from an exemption from control for a period of twelve (12) months.
- > Courier shipments are exempted during the pilot phase.
- > Total FOB value of submitted products below CFAF 1,000,000 (approx. EUR1524)

Prohibited/Banned Products

The following products and substances are prohibited for export to Côte d'Ivoire:

- > Analogue television sets and those not complying with broadcasting and compression standards (Decree No. 2014-604 of October 16, 2014)
- > Cosmetic products whose components are prohibited or regulated by Decree No. 2015-288 of April 29, 2015
- > Freon R22 (Chlorodifluoromethane R22) and products containing R22
- > Asbestos and asbestos products

To find out if your product(s) is subject to regulation, please contact your nearest **Cotecna office** or **Cotecna Côte d'Ivoire**.



CERTIFICATE OF CONFORMITY PROCESS

The conformity assessment process and issuance of Certificates of Conformity (COC) **is performed and delivered in the country of origin or supply**, before shipment to Côte d'Ivoire. The COC will be required for the Customs Clearance and Business Process in Côte d'Ivoire for **every consignment** of products regulated under the Verification of Conformity programme.

1. Documentation verification

To begin the certification process, the exporter/applicant must provide Cotecna with the following documents for verification:

- i) A filled out Cotecna **Request for Certification form**
- ii) Commercial Invoice
- iii) Packing List if available
- iv) Import Declaration Form (Fiche de Déclaration à l'Importation – FDI)
- v) Valid conformity documents (such as laboratory test reports issued by an ISO 17025 accredited laboratory, technical data, analysis certificates.
- vi) Quality Management System certificate and any other relevant documentation.

2. Laboratory testing in the exporting country

If the product test report is not available or is missing essential test criteria, Cotecna will take samples from the shipment and perform the necessary tests in an ISO 17025 accredited laboratory.

3. Physical inspection in exporting country

Cotecna will physically inspect, whenever necessary, the goods and ensure that essential markings comply with Côte d'Ivoire standards, take samples (see above) and seal the container if required.

4. Certificate of Conformity

Cotecna will issue a Certificate of Conformity (COC) only if the product meets the Côte d'Ivoire requirements, following a successful completion of the conformity evaluation. A valid COC will be required by Côte d'Ivoire Customs in the clearance process at import.

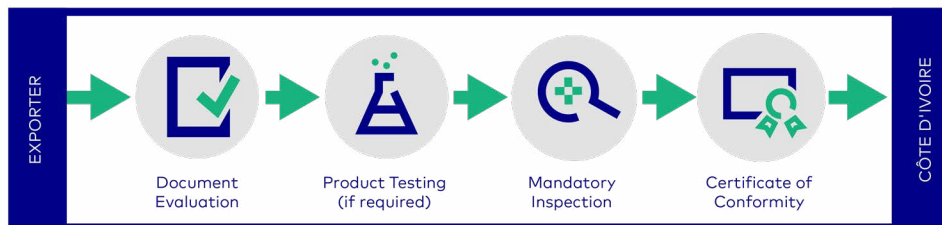


Certification Routes

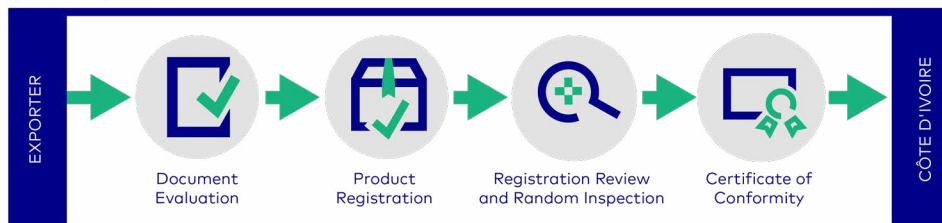
The VOC certification process includes one or a combination of the following kinds of "routes" for verification. These routes help ensure the exported product is compliant with Côte d'Ivoire requirements: National, Regional or International standards. The choice of the route depends on the profile of the exporter and the nature of the goods.

- > **Route A** is ideal for infrequent exporters and mandatory for sensitive products (see Regulated Products for the list of sensitive products).
- > **Route B** is ideal for regular shipments with non-sensitive homogeneous products and exporters whose products are registered.
- > **Route C** is ideal for manufacturers, official distributors and brand owners with regular and high-volume shipments to Côte d'Ivoire and having a Quality Management System (QMS) applied to their production/manufacturing process.

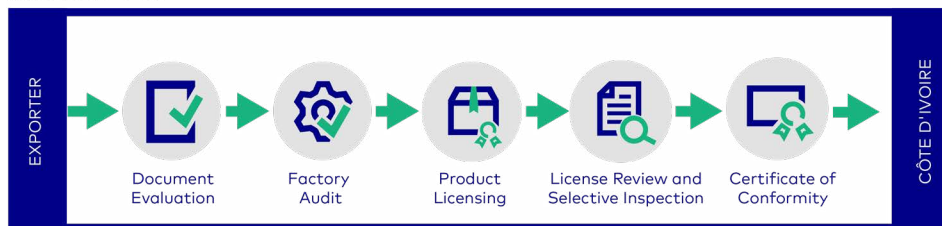
ROUTE A



ROUTE B



ROUTE C



Cotecna will issue a Certificate of Conformity (COC) only if the product meets the Côte d'Ivoire requirements, following a successful completion of the conformity evaluation. A valid COC will be required by Côte d'Ivoire Customs in the clearance process at import.



CERTIFICATION FEES

Route	Applicable fee (% of declared FOB value)	Min fee in FCFA (or approximately in EUR)	Max fee in FCFA (or approximately in EUR)
A	0.45%	197,000 FCFA or 300 EUR	2,684,000 FCFA or 4 100 EUR
B	0.40%	187,150 FCFA or 285 EUR	2,549,800 FCFA or 3 890 EUR
C	0.30%	167,450 FCFA or 255 EUR	2,281,400 FCFA or 3 480 EUR

Above-mentioned fees are net of any duties and taxes and include:

- > Documentary verification
- > Physical inspection
- > Issuance of COC or NCR (Non Conformity Report)

The above-mentioned fees do not include the following:

- > Factory audit
- > Laboratory testing fees
- > Manufacturing Licensing
- > Sampling not done at the time of inspection and sampling of bulk shipments
- > Containers sealing and loading supervision if applicable
- > Re-inspection
- > Fees for additional services may apply

This programme is subject to the **Cotecna General Terms and Conditions**.

Costs of the COC (certification and inspection), sealing and/or analysis are borne by the exporter and are quoted at the time of nomination.

For more information, exporters can contact their nearest **Cotecna office** and importers in Côte d'Ivoire can directly contact: **Cotecna Côte d'Ivoire**.

Disclaimer: This data-sheet has been prepared for information purpose only and is not intended to be nor does it constitute the regulation of the country of importation. Every effort has been made by Cotecna to ensure the accuracy of the information contained herein at the time of its issuance but Cotecna does not guarantee its correctness and takes no responsibility for the contents of this data-sheet, makes no representation as to its accuracy or completeness and expressly disclaims any liability whatsoever for any loss howsoever arising from or in reliance upon the whole or any part of the contents of this data-sheet.

